

Pathwork Guide Lecture No. 240
An Unedited Lecture
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SOME ASPECTS IN THE ANATOMY OF LOVE

My most beloved friends here, blessed are you in your whole being, blessed is your path, blessed are your endeavors to grow and struggle and find your inner truth. The love of the universe permeates all that is. It is always available, it is always here, only many times you are not aware of it through the false direction of your thinking and your focus. When you struggle on your path, you find the many conflicts and confusions and complicated mazes of your mind. But when you work your way through these ever narrowing spiral movements, the issues become so much more simplified. And in the final nuclear point of your being the issue is love. Love is the key to all. Love is the medicine that heals all illness and all sorrow.

We shall talk about aspects of love in this lecture. And we can only speak about aspects. To completely cover that topic would be absolutely impossible in one lifetime even if it were discussed every hour of the day. It is so deep and it is so far-reaching. So we shall discuss those aspects of love which you, my friends, on your path at this juncture are most in need of.

The path, as a whole, goes through certain phases that are relevant to the majority. This is why my friends feel so often that a lecture particularly applies to them. Some of my friends may find the deeper meaning and the greater, more dynamic help perhaps a little later. But in general this topic is what you now need.

A lot of discussion exists in your world about what love really is. To many, it seems to be primarily a feeling. What is it really? Is it a force, is it a feeling, is it an emotion? Now I say to you, my friends, it is all of that and more. Let us speak of the fundamental personality structure in the human being in terms of reason, will, and emotion, and apply love to these functions. In this example we will see that love is literally all and everything.

It is obvious that love is a feeling, but it is not so obvious that this feeling must result from an act of will motivated by intelligence. So love is certainly intelligence. If you truly look at any single issue in depth, in width, and in the full scope that deserves to be brought to any issue, you will have to come to the conclusion that to hate is ignorant, no matter how justified it may appear. It is lack of intelligence. There are, of course, many forms of hatred that are never admitted to be what they are. There are also degrees. Lack of love can simply manifest in separateness, in hopelessness, in lack of faith, in depression, in a bleak vision of the universe, in fears, in feeling victimized. And it can manifest in resentments, blame, hostility, and overt hatred, with many shades of the spectrum in between.

Love is certainly pure intelligence and reason. The deeper the understanding of the prevailing circumstances, the farther the vision goes, the more the person is in possession of the truth of the

issue, the less will it be possible to experience any veiling of the truth by hate, and the more love must grow.

To feel the emotion of love is not possible without the will moving toward being in a loving state. If you do not wish to love, if you do not purposely express the desire to love (that is, to fully understand), if you do not have the intention to love, you will not love. You will never be able to feel love, and you will often wonder why this inability exists in you. Sometimes the will to love stimulates the will to understand fully, and consequently understanding grows from love. Other times the understanding occurs first and results in the will to love. Either way, the feeling of love cannot exist without intelligence and intentionality; or to put it differently, the emotion follows reason and will.

If you have misconceptions that to love is to lose, or to love is being impoverished, or to love is being taken advantage of, or to love means being weak, submissive, and spineless, then these ideas reflect a lack of reason, a lack of intelligence which will hamper your will to love.

Love is also much more than reason, will, and emotion. It is sensation on every level of your being. This is easily verified if you but focus with a modicum of attention to your own reactions. When you are in a state of love, you will see differently; you will hear differently; you will taste differently. Life around you has an altogether different flavor. You will perceive and experience everything that comes to pass in a very different way. You will feel and touch differently.

When you are not in a state of love, your sense perceptions will color experiences that you find undesirable. They will appear unjustified to you. Certainly whatever intelligence is brought to bear on the situation will construct reasons that will justify the reality you want to perceive. In other words, your unloving perceptions will appear absolutely correct. But, my friends, question this. It is only a very limited truth you perceive in this nonloving state. It is, in fact, so limited that you lack reliable perception. You merely perceive isolated fragments or aspects of the truth as it applies to the situation or to your experience of life at this moment.

When you are in a state of love, your body functions very differently. Your breathing is different; your heart and pulse beat are different. Your bloodstream functions differently from when you are in a state of hate, whether or not you are aware of hating. When you love, you remain in a state of health. The lack of health is not necessarily a direct reflection of your hate. However, it may be a necessary by-product of your struggle to find the way out of hate and fear into love and trust. For that is always the inner struggle, again, whether you know it or not.

There are many other experiences, perceptions, sense perceptions, sensations (some of which you do not even know to exist) that are all indications of love, expressions of love, influenced and determined by love. They reflect whether you are in a state of consciousness that is already enlightened into loving or in one that is still unenlightened, defensive, hating, and fearful.

So love is everything. Thus we now come to the very important aspect of loving yourself. Self-love and love for others are intricately connected. Here I need to repeat a statement I have often made. You cannot love yourself if you do not love others, and you cannot love others if you do not love yourself. Conversely, if you hate yourself, you hate others. Again, you may not be

aware of this correlation and of the unconscious process that makes you deny the self-hate and therefore be in need of hating others.

The inner struggle to find the ability to love yourself is unceasing. In that struggle, humanity gets confused by the dualistic state of mind. And that confusion is extremely important for you to understand. The confusion is: if you love yourself, do you then indulge yourself? Do you then follow the line of least resistance? Do you then rather blame others than honestly look into your lower self? Does self-love mean giving free rein to the aspirations of the lower self and of the mask self? On the other hand, does the necessity on the path to face the truth of the lower self and its subterfuges and deceptions and coverings mean that you have to express and live this self-hate imbedded in this aspect of the personality?

This is a very deep and tragic struggle in all of humanity. It is tragic, on the one hand, because to hide from it, to deny it, and thus make it much more painful and prolonged than it need be is so unnecessary. Yet, on the other hand, this struggle is also beautiful. You begin to experience its beauty when you permit yourself to be aware of this struggle, of this confusion, and therefore find your first foothold in true security. Security lies in your first admitting this struggle, in your awareness of this struggle. When you are not aware, you seek the false solution to self-love, which is self-indulgence on the one hand and blaming others on the other hand.

You all know on your path how tempting this game appears and how unsatisfactory, confining, and constricting it really is. It makes you constantly fluctuate in a most painful manner between self-righteous accusations and morbid self-recrimination and guilt. The accusations never deeply convince you because no matter how accurate some of them might be, you suffer the uncertainty that comes from hiding from yourself. Thus you find it impossible to love and esteem yourself on a quite conscious level. You swing between conscious hate for self and hate for others, and that is truly a very painful state that you need not endure if only you find the way out of this maze through the help I can give you here.

Most of you have found this state of fluctuation between hate for self and hate here or there for others. It remains for you to find the places in your inner being where you still live in the pseudosolution of loving yourself by indulging yourself, by blaming others, by excusing and justifying your own lower self traits, and all the more severely heaping accusations on others. Your view of yourself and others is thus always somewhat lopsided. You live in inner turmoil due to the frantic attempt to hide your self-hate from yourself. The more you do this, the more the mistaken part of you believes that this is the way to attain self-love and self-esteem. The true, uncluttered, clear, and guilt-free awareness of other people's wrongdoing, without your own inner wrongdoing, will come when you dispense with this false solution. It will come when you search arduously to attain a truthful balance about facing your lower self honestly and -- not in spite of its discovery but because of it -- loving and honoring yourself the more.

The tragedy of this pseudosolution to your self-hate is that as long as you make use of it, you become further alienated from true self-love and self-esteem. Therefore it is absolutely necessary, if you want to find the real way to love yourself, to ascertain that you lack this balance, that you are on a wrong road in regard to finding your true divine eternal values, that you are trying to eliminate self-hate through false means. The moment you can admit this, you can open your heart and your mind to all your true values that already exist; you can begin to give yourself honest recognition

without hiding and justifications; and, most of all, you can open yourself to the inner inspiration that will guide you to experience how you can acknowledge your lower self without becoming ensnared in self-hate. You will then see clearly that the more you do this, the more you can truly love and respect yourself.

Now, as you love yourself in the true way, without indulging your lower self and its childish demands, you will find that being firm with yourself is as much an expression of love as is tenderness. If you can be firm with yourself, as opposed to self-destruction and unloving total self-devaluation, you can also be tender with yourself. A beautiful balance will emerge clearly: self-discipline, strict honesty with self, firmness with the lower self's desire to act out will create self-honor, tenderness, and deep appreciation for the self. The distortion of this balance is self-indulgence at the expense of others and lacerating self-hate. This distortion is, to begin with, not conscious and needs to be perceived through its indirect manifestations.

Only when you seek and gradually attain the right balance can you be receptive to your own divinity and then finally merge with it, find your identity in it. In a meditation of the deepest sort you bestow tender love upon every aspect of your manifestation, every organ that you neglect loving, every attitude, no matter how distorted. Once you face it in truth, you can find its underlying divinity. But that is genuinely possible only when you no longer excuse, hide, deny, rationalize, project, and hate others in order not to feel your self-hate.

This particular condition is a prison in which you suffer. You are truly suffocated in this prison, and you seek a way out. For the longest time in the evolution of the entity, the search for a way out of this particular prison is not conscious in the manifest mind. When an intense path, such as this one, has been committed to and followed through consistently, then the awareness rises to the surface. At its first emergence this growing awareness is still unrecognized as the inner condition that has always prevailed. Nor is it seen that you are now about to eliminate it through courageously following further. Often it is believed that the "outer" path, the particular orientation of this path, "creates" this growing self-hate. Of course it is not really growing; only the awareness of it is growing, but from the vantage point of the still imprisoned individual, it appears that way. Such a misperception sometimes creates fear of and rage against this path, and the old illusion that the painful feelings of self-rejection are caused by something or someone outside is clung to. In such instances the old pseudosolution is still coveted, be it only in the form of putting the self-doubts to sleep through a one-sided "positive" approach.

However, if this crucial stage on the path is successfully overcome and the temptation to flee it is intelligently recognized for what it is, then the awareness of this particular struggle is already a liberation. But as long as you are under the impression that your lack of freedom is imposed upon you by other factors, people, or conditions, you struggle in vain, and in fact you only pull the chain that ties you tighter.

We come now to another aspect of this problem which I have recently discussed in a smaller setting with some of my friends. I said then that this new aspect is an important step on the path for all of you now and will have to be gone into more thoroughly. Most of you now need to see what I am about to say. The search for liberation and the yearning for freedom has been discussed by us in many different ways. When you rebel against authority figures, you believe that through your rebellion you will attain freedom. When you protest indignantly about every frustration that

life puts in your way, you believe that if there were no frustrations, you would truly be free. Thus you are furious about what you believe is done to you by authority, by frustrations.

Now I would like to shed light on a similar, related reaction, and that is your innate rebellion against any boundaries or structure, against anything that you experience as confining. I say to you here, my friends, structure and boundaries are part of the loving creation. They exist in every facet of reality in one way or another. If there were no law and no boundaries, the world would disintegrate in chaos and destruction. What keeps the planets in their place and prevents them from crashing into one another? It is wise law, it is boundaries and structure. There can be no organization in the universe, big or small, planetary or minuscule; there can be no community of living entities without structure, law, boundaries that may seem to confine some individuals here or there. At least at first it may seem so. In the real sense, it is not so.

It will be of great importance, my friends, to face why you are so angry about this fact of life. Why are you so suspicious of it that it hardly ever occurs to you to be open for the possibility that laws, boundaries, structure, rules -- name it what you will -- come from truth and love, rather than from hostility and a desire to thwart you. Aside from your childhood experiences, or your interpretation of them, the real reason is that you distrust the tyrant of your own lower self that wants to rule selfishly and cruelly. By hiding this aspect, you project it outward so that you assume all rules and laws, all restrictions and boundaries spring from lack of love. When you identify love with indulgence, and frustration with hate, then you are constantly in confusion, in distortion of reality, and in blindness to the magnificence of creation.

Structure and law can be found in every loving aspect of creation. Look at the life of animals -- of birds or ants, for example. Animals free in nature obey the structure of the highest creation in poise, in ease, and with tenderness. They embrace the structure, and breathe and expand within this structure in great freedom. It is a peculiar expression of man that has to do with his own evolutionary scale and the rhythm of his rising consciousness on the one hand and equally with his lower self drives, on the other, that he has an angry rebellion against structure which he interprets as a manifestation hostile to him.

There are, of course, boundaries, laws, and rules in your world, in the human condition, that are a direct expression of man's own limited consciousness: for example, the conflict we discussed before, that comes from using false means to follow the urge to love yourself, and equally from the false means to follow the urge to be free. For freedom and loving are inseparable conditions. You cannot be free without loving, and you cannot love without being free. So when you do not love, you are unfree; you find yourself in the prison of the conflict I mentioned before. You chafe against this prison, this lack of freedom. Your life is full of frustrations, many of them in your inner condition, some of them also manifesting as outer creations. Obviously these infringements and restrictions are not necessary in the strict sense of the word. They are not an intrinsic part of creation in its divine reality. They are roadblocks you yourself are unwittingly putting in your way. They are of a different category than the laws that hold life together. Yet your rebellion and your reactions of outrage against restrictions are not only misplaced, but they also, due to your inappropriate reaction, increase the frustration and restrictions. So you need to develop a new reaction.

First you need to distinguish between the two kinds of boundaries: loving, meaningful ones (whether they are cosmic or human) or the ones created by yourself through error and misperceptions. When you clearly recognize both, it will be much easier to re-educate the willful tyrannical child, and you will be able to lovingly accept both kinds of boundaries: the first in recognition of its intrinsic meaningfulness, the other in recognition of your own past and even present limitations that created them. You can use them in order to better understand yourself and the universal laws. By thus embracing the self-created boundaries, you transcend them most meaningfully. Soon the frustration will become a new doorway to freedom. What first appeared as an infringement will soon be an opportunity to grow and become freer.

You often find yourself in a position in which you rebel against your own tight structure, the structure of your false needs. The need to be always indulged, for example. Again, as long as you fight against it, you only pull the net tighter. Only when you relax your rebellion and open your mind and inner feelers so that you can comprehend what your struggle is really all about, will you see what your own tight structure really means. By temporarily accepting the structure of your own creation with its own inner logic and laws, you can relinquish it, you can grow beyond it, and it can even become a matter of choice.

You constantly overlook the tremendous freedom you possess in the choice you have about how to think, interpret, and react in any given situation. You fail to comprehend that through this choice you have the power to create and change conditions. Instead you are busy demanding from others that they present you with the conditions which you fail to create through choices of different thought-material.

These concepts are of utmost importance for you to understand, my dearest ones. For you continue all too often this unnecessary struggle. The more you rebel against what does not require rebellion and overlook what it is within you that really imposes on you your self-infringement, the less can you find self-love in its true form and the liberation you innately yearn for.

As you accept the narrow structure and recognize it for what it is -- the product of your limited thinking -- so will your scope of freedom widen. But it does not widen by rebelling against the necessary outer boundaries, against what appear to be restrictions. Freedom comes from an intelligent recognition of the structure and from the choice to accept it. This choice is not made out of fear and weakness, dependency and submission; nor is it a rebellion of the inner tyrant which disregards reason and wisdom. It is made with the will to see the truth and meaning and lovingly accept, on those grounds, the narrow structure of the present even if this seems at first to put a restriction on personal desires. This is the act of love and freedom. The first two alternatives are obviously unloving and unfree. They are not deliberate choices, but blind, automatic reactions, and they bear the seed of hate, distrust, suspicion, selfish demands, maligning of truth.

There will come a time when you will find that outer infringements of your freedom diminish steadily. Without childish temper tantrums and blind rebellion, you will be able to dissolve these infringements. In order to attain this ever widening scope of freedom, it is necessary to first find how many times your reactions are thoroughly misplaced. Then you can develop a knowing reaction instead of a blind reaction. This knowing, conscious, probing, objective, deeply honest search for the particular truth under these particular circumstances will immediately fill you with the self-esteem that could never develop when you pursue a road of blind self-will and accusing fury

when the demands of this self-will are not being met. This open mind and heart allows you to love and be free, to be in truth, and thus to trust and respect yourself. You will then see which boundaries, restrictions, and rules are meaningful and which are not meaningful. You will create conditions which make the unmeaningful restrictions unnecessary, and you will tenderly and lovingly embrace and go with the restrictions that you will find meaningful. You will accept them even when this seems to impose at first a momentary disadvantage on you. This open and intelligent frame of mind can be cultivated by you and attained much faster than you think, if only you will stretch your consciousness and make room for this possibility.

Freedom does not mean what the infant imagines: no boundaries at all, always following the line of least resistance. That is the strongest enslavement imaginable. Nothing could be less free. In that attitude you depend constantly on something that cannot be no matter how much you try to force, manipulate, and cajole it. You become the slave of unreality, and reality defeats you.

Now I suggest to all of you, my dearest friends, a small assignment that you may incorporate into your self-observations and your daily review. When you find yourself in rebellion, no matter how you try to explain and justify it, forget for the moment the issue and the pros and cons, but rather focus on what are your feelings. Do you feel rebellious? Do you react blindly? Do you let in other considerations? What is your state of mind? In these questions you will get the clearest answers you need, and you will immediately be able to determine: are you in a state of love, or are you in a state of hate? You can then further ask and compare and think, how do you really feel when you are in a state of love and how does that differ from this rebellious, blind state you find yourself in now.

When you are in a state of love, you do not submit. Submission, in terms of this topic, is the price you wish to pay for the hope of attaining self-love through others or for a benign authority you wish to placate so that it may give you a life of unrestricted indulgence. For this impossible aim, you sacrifice freedom and integrity and then blame the outer world for the result. You conceal the true motives for your submission by pretending that you do so because you are innocent and good and your only problem is that you have not yet learned to rebel and to hate.

In a state of love and freedom, you probe and weigh with an utterly open mind and then choose on the ground of the truth you are able to comprehend in that way. The choice is a totally voluntary act. You may want to choose to embrace and accept a particular infringement of your freedom. In that frame of mind, your choice will be a totally different act from submission. It will make you stronger, freer, more loving to yourself and to others, and open to the condition pertaining to the issue in question. Or, you may reject the infringement in clear, wise, intelligent assertion, in comprehension of the deeper meaning of this choice. Again, this will never be confused with blind rebellion, with the false kind of freedom, but will be as creative an act as the acceptance of the infringement in other circumstances.

You are all coming into new states of consciousness in which these old blind reactions have no longer any room. In the past when they were less obsolete and therefore less of a discrepancy, you would not even feel as uncomfortable as you must feel now when you blindly revert out of old habit to reactions toward yourself and your environment that are already outdated in your state of development. You are no longer in a state in which you need to go on hating yourself when you are not always in perfection. You are already in a condition in which you can truly face aspects of your

lower self and find more of your self-love. You no longer need to blindly rebel against others and hate them when they do something that seems momentarily to your disadvantage or feels unwelcome. You are no longer in a state in which you cannot bear a little frustration. You are already in a state in which a little frustration can become a threshold to freedom and expansion for you. Think about this, my friends. Relinquish the taut, habitual reactions in many, many areas.

And now, before terminating this particular message to you, I would like to speak about a state of evolving love in you that, as a result of your pathwork, you are bound to encounter and that you need to comprehend for what it is. There comes, of course, increasingly the opening up from within, where your heart begins to throb in love -- for others around you, for creation, for the beauty of creation. In this state, you experience of course an intense pleasure that permeates your total being. When self-love has not yet completely been established, in these moments you contract in a frightened reaction, finding yourself unable to endure this state of lovingness, for it is too ecstatic. Inside a tiny voice of self-hate still proclaims that you do not deserve it. And you close yourself up involuntarily, almost in an unbidden reaction on an outer level, against this state. When, in this back and forth struggle of your soul, you increasingly feel the spreading love of the universe but when self-love has not yet quite taken foothold in you, particular kinds of fear may arise. Fear of death, fear of illness, fear of losing what is dearest to you. You may then revert back to the old, drab, gray state to feel more secure and less afraid of loss.

Now it is very important, my friends, that you recognize these manifestations for what they are. When you do not love yourself and therefore hate others in order to deny your self-hate, when you rebel against others and wish impossible false freedoms, then the experience of deepest love for and by the universe will be unbearable, and you will produce false fear. You may experience physical manifestations, as I said before. There are varieties of ways in which the same syndrome can manifest in an individual's life. Whatever it is, there will appear a renewed urge for self-destruction in this halfway period in which more ability to love, feel, and perceive has grown, but remnants of self-hate remain because a stake to hide still exists.

I want to suggest here a very specific meditation, asking the highest forces within and around you in exactly these areas that were discussed in this lecture. Where and how do you hate yourself? Where and how do you project this self-hate onto others and thereby increase the self-hate? Where do you prevent your freedom by childish denial of boundaries and structure, of laws and rules, in small and large areas? And where do you feel within yourself that you are unworthy? Where and how do you love your soul, your mentality, your body? Go deeply into the meditation in which you let yourself know that you are divine, that you need to fully face yourself in all aspects and only increase the sense of divinity. Let your consciousness align itself with the divine will of loving yourself; loving yourself without indulging yourself, without whitewashing your lower self; seeing it straight, and loving your beautiful structure, loving your incarnation, loving all that is around you, even that which seems to infringe in some way on you. Recognize its lesson and begin to love it. This is tonight's message and lecture.

I now bless every single one of you with the golden light of the Christ, with the eternal power of love, of truth, and of beauty. Be enveloped in it, breathe in it, know it, and live it.

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